Units, Measurements & Graphs

Physics study notes

Study snapshot

Use units, precision, and graphs to communicate physical measurements clearly.

Key ideas

- The SI base unit for length is the metre (m).
- Convert units before combining measured quantities.
- Significant figures communicate measurement precision.
- A graph needs labelled axes, units, and a useful scale.
- The gradient of a straight-line graph represents a rate of change.

Try the questions on page 2 before checking your work.

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Quick practice

1. Convert 2.5 km to metres.

2. Write 0.0048 in scientific notation.

3. A distance-time graph has a constant positive gradient. What does that indicate?

4. What should each graph axis include?

Answer notes

1) 2500 m
2) 4.8 x 10^-3
3) Constant positive speed
4) A quantity name and unit

Review the method, then retry any question you missed.